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Working With Linux Environment

What is Linux?

Open-source, Unix-like operating system. Powers servers, phones, embedded devices.

Why Linux?

- Free, stable, secure
- Industry standard for servers, dev environments
- Essential for developers, sysadmins, and researchers

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Basic Commands

`whoami` → shows your current username

`echo "Hello"` → prints text to screen

`which $SHELL` → path of your current shell (e.g., `/bin/bash`)

`cat file.txt` → display file contents

`head -n 5 file.txt` → show first 5 lines

`tail -n 5 file.txt` → show last 5 lines

`ls -l` → list files with details

`vim <filename>` / `nano <filename>`

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Flags

Enable you to expand functionality

`ls -l` → (long format)

`ls -a` → (show hidden)

`ls -la` → (both)

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Shell Script

Script = file containing shell commands executed sequentially

Save with .sh extension. shebang*

Run with `bash script.sh` or `./script.sh` (needs `chmod +x`) **

* shebang specifies which shell to use

** File permissions

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Variables

Assign with `VAR=value` (no spaces)

`export VAR=value`

Access with `$VAR`

Sets a shell variable and marks it as an environment variable.

Temporary: exists only in current shell/session

It becomes part of the shell's environment and is inherited by all child processes.

Any program or subshell you start does not see it.

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User Interaction

Use read to accept input

```
echo "Enter your name:"  
read NAME  
echo "Hi $NAME"
```

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Arguments & Positional Arguments

echo Hello World

0 1 2

Pass args to script: ./script.sh arg1 arg2

Access as \$1, \$2, ... @\$

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Piping

Sending the output of a command as input to another command

```
cat Hello.txt | grep world
```


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Redirection: Output

As the name implies

> - Write to file

>> - Append to file

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Redirection: Input

Read from file

```
wc -w hello.txt -> wc -w < hello.txt
```

<< - used for multiple lines

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Conditionals - if/elif/else

Condition (<, >, ==, !=):

```
${1,,} = John
```

```
if [ <condition> ] ; then
    echo Hello world! I'm a DSA Expert
fi
```

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Conditionals - Case

Instead of multiple if else, you can have a switch case

```
case <condition> in
    <check1> ) { do something } ;;
    <check2> ) { do something else } ;;
    * <default> ) ::
esac
```

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Arrays

Holds multiple objects

```
MY_ARRAY = (one two three four)
```

//each separated by a space is an object not a necessarily a string

Read an array:

```
echo ${MY_ARRAY} *           //outputs only the first element
echo ${MY_ARRAY[@]} **       //outputs all elements
echo ${MY_ARRAY[0]}          //outputs a specific element
```

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For Loop

Reiteration without manual control

```
for item in ${MY_ARRAY[@]}; do  
    ##do something with $item  
done
```

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Functions

```
functionName() { #do something ridiculous }
```

function call:

```
functionName
```

*params are optional and can take positional arguments

** scope of variables



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Exit codes

Every command returns exit code: 0 = success, non-zero = error

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awk

filtering / Pattern scanning / processing

awk '{print \$1}' testfile.txt // print first column. default state uses white space as the separator

adding a flag to determine the separator

awk '{print \$1}' testfile.txt **-F, ***

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sed

altering values in text files
(find/replace)

```
sed 's/{c_from}/{c_to}/g' <filename>
```

s - mode

{c_from} - word to change from

{c_to} - word to change to

g - scope.

adding the i flag makes a duplicate
of the original file before it is
altered

```
sed 's/{c_from}/{c_to}/g'  
<filename>
```



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Final Mini Project

Write a script to automatically build, compile and run your program